

CCVF

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT HANDBOOK

Coventry Chase Volleyball Federation

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Based on the FIVB Official Volleyball Rules (2025-2028)
with CCVF Tournament Modifications

This draft is intended for review, discussion, and approval by the CCVF Tournament Core Group. It does not become binding until formally adopted.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

DC.1 Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Status
0.1	June 2026	Initial working outline	Superseded
1.0	July 2026	Complete draft handbook for review	Current Draft

DC.2 Approval Record

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Tournament Organizer			
Team Captain Representative			
Team Vice-Captain Representative			
Tournament Core Group Approval			

DC.3 Distribution

- Tournament organizers and members of the Tournament Core Group.
- Team Captains and Vice-Captains.
- Match referees, assistant referees, line judges, and official scorers.
- Participating players and approved volunteers.

DC.4 Interpretation

This handbook should be read as a complete governing document. Where a provision is unclear, the Tournament Core Group shall interpret the rule in a manner consistent with fairness, safety, competitive balance, and the spirit of volleyball.

FOREWORD

The Coventry Chase Volleyball Federation was established to provide a structured, competitive, inclusive, and community-centered volleyball environment. This handbook creates one common rule framework for players, team leaders, match officials, volunteers, and tournament organizers.

CCVF follows the FIVB Official Volleyball Rules as its technical foundation. Community-specific modifications are included where needed to support participation, scheduling, safety, and the CCVF playing format. When this handbook differs from the FIVB framework, the CCVF provision controls for CCVF-sanctioned tournaments.

Every participant shares responsibility for the quality of the tournament. Players compete. Captains communicate. Officials apply the rules. Volunteers keep the event moving. The Core Group protects fairness and consistency. Together, these roles turn a schedule of matches into a trusted competition.

FAIR PLAY STATEMENT: Every decision under this handbook shall be guided by fairness, consistency, transparency, safety, and sportsmanship.

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COMPETITION REGULATIONS AT A GLANCE

This page is a summary only. The numbered Articles control whenever a question requires detailed interpretation.

Category	CCVF Tournament Regulation
League Match Format	Best of 3 sets; each set to 25; win by 2; no point cap.
Championship Final	Best of 5 sets; Sets 1-4 to 25; Set 5 to 15; win by 2.
Match Points	2-0 win: 3 MP; 2-1 win: 2 MP; 2-1 loss: 1 MP.
Seeding Order	Match Points, Set Ratio, Point Ratio, Head-to-Head, Coin Toss.
Match-Day Roster	No limit on listed team members.
Participating Players	4 to 8 players must be declared before each match.
Starting Formation	Up to 6 on court; a 7th and 8th player may serve as flank players.
Flank Rotation	Flank exchanges occur at Positions 4 and 2 under Article 10.
Minimum to Start	4 declared Participating Players.
Team Time-outs	Two per team per set; each lasts 2 minutes.
Interval Between Sets	8 minutes unless shortened by the Core Group for scheduling.
League Coin Toss	Designated Home Team calls the toss.
Semi-Final / Final Toss	First team to secure its bracket place calls the toss.
Officiating	Assigned non-playing team provides officials and scorer unless otherwise designated.
Late Arrival Grace Period	15 minutes, subject to Article 8 and Core Group authority.

IMPORTANT: The declared Participating Players List locks eligibility for that match. Team members not declared as Participating Players remain listed as substitutes/inactive and may not enter play unless an exceptional replacement is approved under Article 13.

ARTICLE 1 - PURPOSE AND AUTHORITY

This Article establishes the legal and operational authority of the handbook within CCVF-sanctioned competition.

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this handbook is to create a consistent framework for organizing, administering, officiating, and participating in CCVF tournaments.

- Promote fair and consistent competition.
- Define player, team, official, volunteer, and organizer responsibilities.
- Protect participant safety and tournament integrity.
- Provide clear procedures for eligibility, scheduling, protests, and discipline.
- Preserve the spirit of volleyball while supporting the CCVF community format.

1.2 Scope

This handbook governs every tournament, match, playoff, exhibition, or related event formally sanctioned by CCVF unless an event bulletin expressly states an approved variation.

1.3 Authority

The CCVF Tournament Core Group is the final governing authority for interpretation and enforcement of this handbook. Match referees exercise authority during a match, subject to review under Article 14 where a protest is permitted.

1.4 Rule Hierarchy

When two provisions appear to conflict, the following order shall apply:

1. CCVF Tournament Regulations contained in this handbook.
2. The official event bulletin or supplemental regulation approved by the Tournament Core Group.
3. The current FIVB Official Volleyball Rules.
4. A formal decision of the Tournament Core Group addressing an unforeseen situation.

1.5 No Waiver by Informal Practice

A rule is not changed merely because a prior match was administered differently. Only an approved amendment, event bulletin, or formal Core Group decision may modify the governing regulation.

1.6 Amendments

- The handbook may be reviewed and revised between tournament seasons.
- Mid-tournament changes should be avoided and may be made only for safety, legal compliance, material operational necessity, or unanimous Core Group approval.
- Approved amendments shall identify the version number, approval date, and effective date.

ARTICLE 2 - MISSION, VISION, AND CORE VALUES

CCVF competition is built around strong play, shared responsibility, and respect for the community that makes the tournament possible.

2.1 Mission

To foster a competitive, inclusive, respectful, and well-organized volleyball community in which players can develop, compete, and contribute.

2.2 Vision

To become a trusted community volleyball organization recognized for fair competition, dependable administration, strong sportsmanship, and memorable tournament experiences.

2.3 Core Values

Value	Expected Practice
Respect	Treat teammates, opponents, officials, volunteers, and spectators with dignity.
Integrity	Compete honestly and accept responsibility for conduct and decisions.
Excellence	Prepare seriously, play purposefully, and improve continuously.
Teamwork	Support the team on and off the court and fulfill assigned duties.
Community	Strengthen relationships through participation, service, and inclusion.
Safety	Protect physical well-being through responsible play and event management.

2.4 Participant Commitment

Participation in a CCVF event constitutes agreement to follow this handbook, accept the authority of match officials and the Tournament Core Group, and uphold the standards of conduct in Article 12.

ARTICLE 3 - TOURNAMENT STRUCTURE

This Article defines the standard CCVF competition format. Event-specific brackets may be published separately, but scoring and seeding shall remain governed by this handbook unless formally modified.

3.1 Competition Phases

- League or Group Stage.
- Playoff or qualification stage, when scheduled.
- Semi-Finals, when scheduled.
- Championship Final.
- Placement matches, when included in the official event bulletin.

3.2 League Match Format

- Best of three (3) sets.
- All sets are played to twenty-five (25) points.
- A set must be won by a minimum margin of two (2) points.
- There is no point cap unless a published emergency schedule regulation applies.

3.3 Championship Final Format

- Best of five (5) sets.
- Sets 1 through 4 are played to twenty-five (25) points.
- The deciding fifth set is played to fifteen (15) points.
- Every set must be won by a minimum margin of two (2) points.

3.4 Match Points

Match Result	Winner MP	Loser MP
2-0	3	0
2-1	2	1

3.5 Standings Terminology

Abbreviation	Meaning	Calculation
MP	Match Points	Points awarded under Section 3.4.
SW	Sets Won	Total sets won.
SL	Sets Lost	Total sets lost.
SR	Set Ratio	SW divided by SL. If SL is zero, the event system shall rank the undefeated ratio above finite ratios.
PF	Points For	Total rally points scored.

Abbreviation	Meaning	Calculation
PA	Points Against	Total rally points conceded.
PR	Point Ratio	PF divided by PA.

3.6 Seeding and Tie-Break Order

Teams tied in the standings shall be separated in the following order:

5. Match Points (MP).
6. Set Ratio (SR).
7. Point Ratio (PR).
8. Head-to-Head result between the tied teams.
9. Coin toss administered by the Tournament Core Group.

3.7 Multiple-Team Ties

When three or more teams are tied, the criteria shall be applied in order to the tied group. After one team is separated, the process shall restart from Match Points among the remaining tied teams unless the event scoring system automatically applies an equivalent method.

3.8 Official Standings

Only standings issued or confirmed by the Tournament Core Group are official. Captains should promptly report any apparent scoring or data-entry error.

ARTICLE 4 - TEAM REGISTRATION AND ELIGIBILITY

CCVF distinguishes between the unlimited match-day roster and the smaller group of Participating Players who are eligible to enter a specific match.

4.1 Match-Day Roster

There is no limit on the number of team members who may be listed on a team's match-day roster, subject to overall tournament registration and eligibility requirements.

4.2 Participating Players List

Before each match, the Captain, Vice-Captain, or Match Captain shall submit a Participating Players List to the Match Referee and/or Tournament Core Group.

- The list may contain four (4), five (5), six (6), seven (7), or eight (8) players.
- Eight (8) is the maximum number of players eligible to participate in one match.
- The list should identify the Captain or Match Captain and, when applicable, the flank-player assignments.
- The list becomes locked when accepted by the Match Referee or Tournament Core Group before the first serve.

4.3 Starting Formation

Declared Players	Starting Formation
4	Four players begin on court.
5	Five players begin on court.
6	Six players begin on court.
7	Six players begin on court and one player is assigned as the single flank player under Section 10.7.
8	Six players begin on court and two players are assigned to the flank positions under Article 10.

4.4 Substitutes / Inactive Team Members

All other team members may remain listed on the match-day roster as substitutes or inactive team members. They may support the team from the designated team area but are not eligible to enter play unless an exceptional replacement is approved under Article 13.

4.5 Minimum Players to Start

A team may begin a match with a minimum of four (4) declared Participating Players. A team falling below the minimum required to continue shall be handled under Sections 8.4 and 13.7.

4.6 Player Eligibility

- Only properly registered and approved team members may be listed.

- A player may not represent more than one team in the same tournament unless the Core Group has approved a special community format before the event.
- An ineligible or undeclared player may not enter the court.
- The Core Group may request identity or registration verification when reasonably necessary.

4.7 Match Check-In

Teams should report at least fifteen (15) minutes before the scheduled match for player verification, Participating Players submission, coin toss, warm-up, and lineup confirmation.

LOCKED LIST RULE: Once the Participating Players List is accepted, tactical activation of an inactive roster member is not permitted. Changes are limited to exceptional replacement under Article 13.

ARTICLE 5 - TOURNAMENT GOVERNANCE

The Tournament Core Group protects consistency across matches and resolves issues that extend beyond the authority of a single match referee.

5.1 Tournament Authority

The Tournament Core Group governs all CCVF-sanctioned tournaments and has final authority over scheduling, eligibility, interpretation, disputes, discipline, and emergency administration.

5.2 Core Group Composition

- Tournament Organizers.
- Team Captains.
- Team Vice-Captains.
- Other individuals invited by the Core Group for a specific technical or administrative purpose.

5.3 Responsibilities

- Publish schedules, brackets, court assignments, and event notices.
- Confirm standings and seeding.
- Interpret CCVF regulations and address unforeseen situations.
- Review eligibility, player replacement, protest, and disciplinary matters.
- Coordinate weather, safety, delay, and rescheduling decisions.
- Protect fairness and avoid preferential treatment.

5.4 Official Communication

The Core Group shall identify the official communication platform for the event. Captains and Vice-Captains are responsible for monitoring notices and relaying relevant information to their teams.

5.5 Rescheduling Requests

- Requests should be submitted as early as possible and preferably at least twelve (12) hours before the scheduled match.
- A valid reason, opponent coordination, court availability, and overall schedule impact shall be considered.
- Agreement between teams does not by itself guarantee approval.
- The Core Group has final authority to approve, deny, or modify a rescheduling request.

5.6 Match Delay Notice

A delayed team shall notify the Core Group immediately. Notification alone does not postpone the match. The Core Group or Match Referee shall determine whether play proceeds, a limited delay is granted, the match is rescheduled, or a forfeit applies.

5.7 Conflict of Interest and Neutrality

A Core Group member with a direct personal interest in a dispute should disclose the conflict and, where practical, abstain from the final decision. Match officials shall apply rules impartially regardless of team affiliation.

5.8 Records

The Core Group should maintain schedules, results, standings, disciplinary decisions, approved replacements, and major rulings for the duration of the tournament and a reasonable review period afterward.

ARTICLE 6 - TEAM LEADERSHIP

Team leaders are the official communication bridge between players, match officials, and tournament administration.

6.1 Captain

- Represent the team in the Tournament Core Group.
- Submit or approve the Participating Players List and starting lineup.
- Participate in the coin toss when present.
- Communicate respectfully with match officials.
- Raise permitted protests under Article 14.
- Ensure team compliance with schedules, conduct rules, and volunteer duties.

6.2 Vice-Captain

The Vice-Captain assists the Captain and assumes the Captain's responsibilities whenever the Captain is unavailable or unable to act.

6.3 Match Captain

If both the Captain and Vice-Captain are absent, the team shall designate a Match Captain from among the declared Participating Players. The Match Captain has full captain authority for that match only.

6.4 Bench and Team-Area Control

The Captain or Match Captain is responsible for helping maintain order in the team area and ensuring that inactive members, substitutes, and supporters do not interfere with officials or play.

6.5 Team Responsibilities

- Arrive on time and complete check-in.
- Provide eligible players and accurate roster information.
- Wear safe and reasonably distinguishable playing attire.
- Respect opponents, officials, volunteers, and spectators.
- Fulfill assigned officiating and scoring responsibilities.
- Leave the playing area clean and ready for the next match.

6.6 Communication Standard

Questions should be raised calmly and through the Captain or Match Captain. Repeated arguing, crowding an official, or hostile communication may be sanctioned under Article 12.

ARTICLE 7 - MATCH ADMINISTRATION

A consistent match-start procedure reduces confusion and protects competitive fairness.

7.1 Match Officials

Unless the Core Group approves a reduced crew, the standard match crew consists of:

- Main Referee.
- Assistant Referee.
- Two Line Judges.
- Official Scorer.

7.2 Community Officiating Assignment

An assigned non-playing team shall provide the required officials and scorer unless the Tournament Core Group appoints another crew. Failure to fulfill an assignment may result in corrective action or a tournament sanction.

7.3 Official Reporting Time

Officials should report at least fifteen (15) minutes before the match to inspect the court and equipment, review team lists, prepare the scoresheet, administer the coin toss, and confirm readiness.

7.4 Pre-Match Verification

- Court surface and boundary lines are safe and visible.
- Net, antennas when used, posts, and padding are reasonably secure.
- The official ball is available.
- Participating Players Lists and starting lineups are complete.
- The Captain or Match Captain is identified.
- Officials and scorer understand their assignments.

7.5 Coin Toss - League / Group Stage

The designated Home Team shall call the coin toss. The winner chooses one of the following: first serve, first receive, or court side. The opponent receives the remaining choice consistent with normal volleyball procedure.

7.6 Coin Toss - Semi-Finals and Championship Final

The first team to secure its place in the Semi-Final or Championship Final bracket shall call the coin toss.

7.7 Warm-Up

Warm-up begins when the court becomes available and shall be managed so both teams receive a fair opportunity. The Core Group may publish a standardized warm-up duration for the event.

7.8 Scoresheet and Rally Record

The Official Scorer shall record set scores, time-outs, declared lineups or rotation order, sanctions, and other required match events. A digital tournament tracker may serve as the official record when approved by the Core Group.

7.9 Match Commencement

The Main Referee authorizes the first serve only after the court, teams, officials, and scoring record are ready.

7.10 Authority During the Match

The Main Referee has final on-court authority for factual and judgment decisions during play. Questions of rule application may be protested only through Article 14.

ARTICLE 8 - MATCH DELAY AND FORFEIT

The goal is to begin matches on time while allowing the Core Group limited discretion for genuine emergencies and conditions outside a team's control.

8.1 Scheduled Start Time

Teams are expected to be ready at the published start time. Check-in and warm-up should be completed before that time whenever court availability permits.

8.2 Grace Period

A team that is not ready may receive a maximum grace period of fifteen (15) minutes. The grace period is not automatic and may be shortened when the schedule, facility, or prior warning requires prompt administration.

8.3 Grounds for Forfeit

- Failure to be ready within the permitted grace period.
- Fewer than four (4) eligible Participating Players at match start.
- Refusal to continue after the referee directs play to resume.
- Use of an ineligible or undeclared player.
- Serious misconduct that makes safe continuation impossible.

8.4 Incomplete Team During Match

If injury, disqualification, or other loss reduces a team below the minimum required to continue, the referee shall allow a reasonable opportunity to apply Article 13. If no lawful replacement is available, the team may be declared incomplete and the match awarded to the opponent.

8.5 Forfeit Result

The Tournament Core Group shall record the official match, set, and standings consequence in the tournament system. The event bulletin may establish a standardized administrative score.

8.6 Exceptional Circumstances

The Core Group may waive or modify a forfeit when delay or non-appearance results from a medical emergency, severe weather, facility failure, transportation emergency affecting multiple participants, or another extraordinary circumstance.

8.7 Repeated Delay

Repeated lateness, even when within a grace period, may be treated as an administrative or conduct issue and may lead to scheduling restrictions or other sanctions.

ARTICLE 9 - MATCH PLAY REGULATIONS

CCVF uses rally scoring and the FIVB technical framework, modified by the time-out, interval, roster, minimum-player, and flank-rotation provisions in this handbook.

9.1 Official Playing Rules

All matches shall be conducted under the current FIVB Official Volleyball Rules except where this handbook or an approved event bulletin expressly provides otherwise.

9.2 Court and Equipment

- The playing surface shall be reasonably level, visible, and free from hazards.
- Boundary lines shall be identifiable to players and officials.
- The net shall be installed at the event-approved height and tension.
- Posts and nearby obstacles should be padded or positioned to reduce risk.
- The Match Referee may suspend play when the court or equipment is unsafe.

9.3 Rally Scoring

Every completed rally results in one point. A team scores when it legally grounds the ball in the opponent's court, the opponent commits a fault, or the opponent receives a penalty carrying a point.

9.4 Winning a Set

A set is won by the first team to reach the required target score with a two-point advantage. There is no point cap unless an emergency schedule regulation is formally announced before the affected set.

9.5 Winning the Match

- League / Group Stage: first team to win two (2) sets.
- Championship Final: first team to win three (3) sets.

9.6 Team Time-Outs

- Each team is entitled to two (2) team time-outs per set.
- Each team time-out lasts two (2) minutes.
- Unused time-outs do not carry over to another set.
- Only the Captain, Match Captain, or recognized team representative may request a time-out when the ball is out of play and before authorization for the next serve.

9.7 Interval Between Sets

The standard interval between completed sets is eight (8) minutes. The Core Group may shorten an interval for scheduling or safety reasons, provided both teams are informed and treated consistently.

9.8 Change of Courts

Teams change courts between sets and during a deciding set as required by the event format and the referee's instructions. The Core Group may waive court changes when facility layout or safety makes the change impractical.

9.9 Injury During Play

- The referee shall stop play when an injury appears serious or creates immediate risk.
- Reasonable first aid and assessment time may be allowed.

- Return to play is permitted only when the player can continue safely.
- Replacement eligibility is governed by Article 13.

9.10 External Interference

When a ball, person, object, weather condition, lighting failure, or other external factor materially interferes with a rally, the referee may stop play and order a replay.

9.11 No Deliberate Delay

Teams shall be ready to resume promptly after time-outs, intervals, injury assessment, or official consultation. Deliberate delay may result in a warning or sanction.

ARTICLE 10 - CCVF FLANK ROTATION SYSTEM

The flank rotation system is a CCVF-specific participation format. It allows seven or eight declared players to share continuous play without ordinary tactical substitution.

10.1 Purpose

- Increase meaningful participation.
- Distribute workload and reduce fatigue.
- Preserve a continuous rotation order.
- Maintain a simple, visible exchange process for players and officials.

10.2 Applicability

The flank rotation system applies when a team declares seven (7) or eight (8) Participating Players. Teams declaring four (4), five (5), or six (6) players use the ordinary on-court rotation among the available players.

10.3 Eight-Player Formation

Six players begin on the court. One player begins at the left flank exchange area associated with Position 4, and one player begins at the right flank exchange area associated with Position 2.

10.4 Authorized Exchange Points

- Position 4 - Front Left exchange point.
- Position 2 - Front Right exchange point.
- No flank exchange may occur at another court position unless the referee is correcting an error.

10.5 Eight-Player Exchange Procedure

Whenever the team is required to rotate after gaining the right to serve, both flank exchanges occur as part of the same rotation:

10. The player occupying Position 4 exits to the left flank area.
11. The player waiting at the left flank enters Position 4.
12. The player occupying Position 2 exits to the right flank area.
13. The player waiting at the right flank enters Position 2.
14. All remaining on-court players complete the normal clockwise rotation.

This creates one continuous eight-player circuit. A player who enters through Position 4 can later exit through Position 2, and a player who enters through Position 2 can later exit through Position 4, preserving equal circulation through the two flank areas.

10.6 Exchange Timing

A flank exchange occurs only during a legal team rotation and before the next serve. Flank players may not enter or leave during a rally or merely because a team requests a tactical change.

10.7 Seven-Player Formation

When seven (7) players are declared, six begin on court and one begins as the flank player. Before the set, the team shall declare whether the active exchange point is Position 4 or Position 2. The selected exchange point remains in effect for the set unless the referee approves a change to correct injury or administration.

DRAFT IMPLEMENTATION NOTE: Section 10.7 uses one declared exchange point for seven-player play. The Core Group should confirm this operating method before final approval of Version 1.0.

10.8 Rotation Order and Tracking

The team shall maintain the declared rotation order. The scorer or referee may record the sequence or jersey numbers when necessary to verify legal exchanges.

10.9 Illegal Flank Rotation

- A player enters from an unauthorized exchange point.
- A player enters during a rally or without a legal rotation.
- An undeclared or inactive team member enters play.
- The team fails to preserve the approved rotation sequence.
- More than the permitted number of players are on the court.

10.10 Correction and Penalty

The referee shall stop play at the first appropriate opportunity, restore the correct formation, and apply the fault or administrative consequence required by the point at which the error was discovered. Points scored while an ineligible player participated may be reviewed by the Core Group.

10.11 Referee Authority

The Main Referee has final authority during the match to determine correct rotation, exchange timing, player eligibility, and required correction. A permitted rule-application protest remains available under Article 14.

10.12 Diagram

The official court diagrams and rotation examples in Appendix A form part of this Article.

ARTICLE 11 - PLAYING ACTIONS AND FAULTS

This Article summarizes the most frequently applied playing rules. The FIVB rules remain the technical reference for situations not expressly modified by CCVF.

11.1 Maximum Team Contacts

A team is entitled to a maximum of three contacts to return the ball, in addition to a legal block contact. A fourth team contact is a fault.

11.2 Characteristics of Contact

- The ball may contact any part of the body.
- The ball must rebound and may not be caught, carried, thrown, or held.
- Simultaneous contacts by teammates count according to the number of players contacting the ball, except where the blocking rule applies.
- A player may not contact the ball twice consecutively except when permitted after a block or during one continuous first-team-contact action under the applicable FIVB interpretation.

11.3 Service

- The server shall serve from behind the end line within the service zone.
- The service must occur after the referee authorizes service.
- The server may not touch the court, end line, or ground outside the service zone at the moment of service contact.
- The team shall follow the declared service and rotation order.

11.4 Service Screening

Players may not deliberately prevent the receiving team from seeing the server or the flight of the served ball through collective movement, grouping, or raised arms.

11.5 Attack Hit

An attack hit is any action that directs the ball toward the opponent other than a serve or block. Front-row and back-row restrictions shall follow the FIVB rules unless a CCVF event bulletin expressly modifies them.

11.6 Blocking

- A block is an action near the net by a front-row player to intercept the opponent's ball above the top of the net.
- A block contact does not count as one of the team's three contacts.
- The first contact after a block may be made by any player, including the blocker.
- Blocking the opponent's service is prohibited.

11.7 Net Contact

Contact with the net is a fault when it occurs between the antennas during the action of playing the ball or when it materially interferes with play. Incidental contact outside the action may be judged under the current FIVB standard.

11.8 Center Line and Opponent Court

A player may cross under the net only to the extent allowed by the FIVB center-line rule and only when the action does not interfere with the opponent or create a safety risk.

11.9 Reaching Beyond the Net

A player may not interfere with the opponent's legal play before or during the opponent's attack. Follow-through beyond the net may be permitted after the player has legally contacted the ball on their own side.

11.10 Ball In

The ball is in when any part of the ball touches the playing court, including a boundary line.

11.11 Ball Out

- The ball lands completely outside the boundary lines.
- The ball contacts an object, person, ceiling, or structure outside the legal playing area, subject to any facility-specific ground rule.
- The ball crosses the net completely outside the crossing space and is not legally recovered.
- The ball contacts an antenna or passes outside it.

11.12 Simultaneous Faults

When opponents commit faults simultaneously, the rally shall be replayed unless one fault clearly occurred first or a sanction independently determines the result.

11.13 Judgment Calls

Ball-handling quality, net interference, touch, in/out, and similar factual judgments belong to the officiating crew and are not appealable merely because a team disagrees.

ARTICLE 12 - PLAYER CONDUCT AND DISCIPLINE

CCVF expects intense competition without hostility. The tournament should feel serious on the court and welcoming around it.

12.1 Sportsmanship Standard

- Compete honestly and respectfully.
- Accept referee decisions without abuse or intimidation.
- Avoid taunting, discriminatory language, threats, and deliberate provocation.
- Shake hands or otherwise acknowledge opponents after the match when circumstances permit.
- Support a safe, family-friendly event environment.

12.2 Captain Communication

Only the Captain or Match Captain should request a rule explanation or clarification during play. Other players may communicate ordinary playing information but shall not collectively confront an official.

12.3 Minor Misconduct

Low-level frustration or isolated inappropriate conduct may be managed through a verbal reminder or formal warning. A warning is preventive and does not necessarily carry a point penalty.

12.4 Sanctionable Misconduct

Rude conduct, repeated dissent, aggressive confrontation, threats, discriminatory abuse, deliberate disruption, or physical misconduct may result in a penalty, expulsion from the set, disqualification from the match, or referral to the Core Group.

12.5 Progressive Discipline

Where appropriate, officials may use a progressive sequence of warning, penalty, expulsion, and disqualification. Serious conduct may justify an immediate higher sanction without prior warning.

12.6 Bench and Team Area

Inactive players, substitutes, coaches, and supporters in the team area are subject to the same conduct standards. Misconduct by a person associated with a team may be charged to that team when the individual cannot be separately administered.

12.7 Spectator Conduct

- Spectators may support teams but may not threaten, harass, or obstruct players or officials.
- The referee may pause play while the Core Group addresses spectator interference.
- A spectator may be removed from the playing area when necessary for safety or order.

12.8 Physical Altercation

Any fighting, attempted fighting, or intentional physical aggression shall result in immediate removal from the match area and referral to the Tournament Core Group for further discipline.

12.9 Post-Match Conduct

Conduct rules continue after the final whistle. Abuse directed at officials, opponents, or tournament staff after a match may be sanctioned even though play has ended.

12.10 Core Group Discipline

The Core Group may impose match suspension, tournament suspension, loss of leadership role, volunteer-duty sanctions, or other proportionate action after reviewing the circumstances and allowing the affected person or team a reasonable opportunity to respond.

ARTICLE 13 - PLAYER REPLACEMENT POLICY

The locked Participating Players List protects fairness. Exceptional replacement exists only to address genuine injury, emergency, or unforeseen loss of availability.

13.1 General Rule

A team may not activate an inactive match-day roster member for tactical reasons after the Participating Players List has been accepted.

13.2 Permitted Grounds

- Injury or sudden medical condition.
- Family or personal emergency requiring a declared player to leave.
- Another unforeseen circumstance that makes continued participation impossible.
- Correction of an administrative error confirmed before the replacement enters play.

13.3 Approval Authority

The Match Referee may approve an immediate temporary solution needed to continue safely. The Tournament Core Group has final authority over an exceptional replacement and any effect on eligibility or standings.

13.4 Eligible Replacement Source

The replacement must be a registered and otherwise eligible team member listed on the match-day roster as a substitute or inactive team member. A person not registered with the team may not be added during the match without extraordinary Core Group approval.

13.5 Replacement Procedure

The Captain or Match Captain shall notify the referee, identify the unavailable player and proposed replacement, and explain the reason. The scorer shall record the approved change before the replacement enters.

13.6 Rotation Position

The replacement assumes the unavailable player's place in the approved rotation or flank sequence. The referee may adjust the formation only as necessary to preserve a legal order.

13.7 Return of Replaced Player

Unless the referee approved a temporary blood-control or equipment-related interruption, a player exceptionally replaced for injury or emergency may not return during the same match without Core Group approval.

13.8 No Available Replacement

If no lawful replacement is available, the team may continue with fewer players so long as at least four (4) eligible players remain and the formation can be administered safely. If fewer than four remain, Article 8 applies.

13.9 Abuse of Replacement Rule

Misrepresentation of an injury or emergency, or use of the policy for tactical advantage, may result in reversal of the replacement, forfeiture, and disciplinary review.

ARTICLE 14 - PROTESTS AND APPEALS

A protest addresses an alleged misapplication of a rule or administrative regulation. It is not a second opinion on an official's judgment call.

14.1 Who May Protest

Only the team Captain, Vice-Captain acting as Captain, or Match Captain may lodge a protest on behalf of the team.

14.2 Permitted Grounds

- Incorrect application or interpretation of a written rule.
- Use of an ineligible or undeclared player.
- Material scoring, rotation, roster, or match-administration error.
- Failure to follow an approved tournament regulation that could affect the match outcome.

14.3 Non-Protestable Matters

- Ball-handling judgment.
- Net-contact judgment.
- Touch or no-touch judgment.
- Ball in or out judgment.
- Any other factual call made within the official's normal discretion.

14.4 Immediate Notice

When possible, the Captain shall notify the Main Referee before the next serve that the team believes a rule is being misapplied. The referee should briefly explain the ruling and ensure the scorer notes the protest if the team maintains it.

14.5 Written Submission

A formal protest should be submitted to the Tournament Core Group within thirty (30) minutes after the match unless the Core Group publishes another deadline. The submission should identify the match, set, score, rule, facts, requested remedy, and names of available witnesses.

14.6 Review

The Core Group may consult the scoresheet, digital rally log, officials, captains, video when available, and relevant rules. Review should be prompt enough to protect the tournament schedule.

14.7 Possible Remedies

- Confirm the original result.
- Correct a record or standings entry.
- Resume or replay a portion of a match when practical and fair.
- Order a full replay in an exceptional case.
- Apply an eligibility, forfeit, or disciplinary consequence.

14.8 Final Decision

The Tournament Core Group's written or officially communicated decision is final within CCVF competition.

14.9 Good-Faith Requirement

A protest must be made in good faith. Repetitive or abusive protests intended to delay play or pressure officials may be sanctioned under Article 12.

ARTICLE 15 - SAFETY AND MEDICAL POLICIES

Safety takes priority over schedule, standings, and competitive advantage. Every participant must act when a condition appears dangerous.

15.1 General Duty of Care

Players, captains, officials, and organizers shall promptly report unsafe court conditions, serious injury, hazardous weather, or other immediate risks.

15.2 Warm-Up and Readiness

- Players are responsible for warming up appropriately.
- Teams should avoid uncontrolled hitting or serving when others are crossing the court.
- A player should not participate while knowingly impaired by an injury or condition that creates a serious risk.

15.3 Hydration and Heat

- Water and reasonable hydration access should be available.
- The Core Group may add recovery breaks, extend intervals, shorten warm-ups, reschedule matches, or suspend play during excessive heat.
- Players showing signs of heat illness shall be removed from play and assessed promptly.

15.4 Lightning and Severe Weather

Outdoor play shall be suspended when lightning, severe wind, heavy rain, poor visibility, or another weather condition creates an unreasonable risk. Play may resume only after the responsible tournament authority determines conditions are safe.

15.5 Medical Emergency

For a suspected serious injury or medical emergency, play shall stop, emergency services should be contacted when appropriate, and the area shall be cleared for assistance. No match schedule takes priority over emergency care.

15.6 Blood and Bodily Fluids

A player with active bleeding shall leave the court until bleeding is controlled and contaminated clothing or equipment is cleaned or replaced. A short temporary interruption may be allowed before an Article 13 replacement is required.

15.7 Jewelry and Unsafe Equipment

Players shall remove or secure jewelry and equipment that could create a reasonable injury risk. Medical or religious items may be permitted when safely covered or secured.

15.8 Court and Facility Hazards

- Wet or slippery surface.
- Unpadded post or dangerous obstruction.
- Loose net system or damaged ball.
- Poor lighting or visibility.
- Spectator or equipment encroachment into the safety area.

15.9 Authority to Suspend or Terminate

The Main Referee may suspend a match for immediate safety reasons. The Tournament Core Group may postpone, relocate, resume, or terminate the match after considering safety, fairness, and schedule impact.

15.10 Return to Play

A player may return after an injury or medical interruption only when able to participate safely. The referee may rely on the player, responsible adult, medical professional, or Core Group depending on the seriousness of the condition.

15.11 Incident Record

Serious injuries, emergency service involvement, altercations, or material safety incidents should be documented by the Tournament Core Group.

APPENDIX A - CCVF FLANK ROTATION DIAGRAMS

These diagrams are schematic. The team's playing court is shown from the team's own baseline, with the net at the top.

LEFT FLANK	P4 Front Left	P3 Front Center	P2 Front Right
	P5 Back Left	P6 Back Center	P1 Back Right
	BASELINE / SERVICE AREA		RIGHT FLANK

Figure A-1. Starting layout for an eight-player team.

A.1 Eight-Player Rotation Event

15. All six on-court players rotate clockwise when the team gains the right to serve.
16. The player at Position 4 exits to the left flank; the left-flank player enters Position 4.
17. The player at Position 2 exits to the right flank; the right-flank player enters Position 2.
18. The scorer or referee confirms that six players remain on the court before the serve.

Before Rotation	Action	After Rotation
P4 player on court	Exits left	Waits at left flank
Left flank player waiting	Enters P4	Becomes on-court P4
P2 player on court	Exits right	Waits at right flank
Right flank player waiting	Enters P2	Becomes on-court P2

A.2 Seven-Player Rotation

One player begins off court at the exchange point declared before the set. Only that exchange point is active for the set under the current draft rule in Section 10.7.

CORE GROUP REVIEW ITEM: Confirm whether seven-player teams will use one fixed exchange point per set or an alternating single-flank sequence before Version 1.0 is approved.

APPENDIX B - PARTICIPATING PLAYERS LIST

This form may be reproduced or implemented digitally. It should be submitted before the first serve.

Match Information	Entry
Tournament	
Date	
Scheduled Time	
Court	
Team	
Opponent	
Captain / Match Captain	

Declared Participating Players (minimum 4, maximum 8):

No.	Player Name	Jersey No.	Initial Assignment
1			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
2			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
3			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
4			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
5			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
6			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
7			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank
8			On Court / Left Flank / Right Flank

Remaining registered team members present at the match may be listed below as substitutes / inactive:

No.	Name	Jersey No.
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		

Certification	Signature / Confirmation
Team Captain / Match Captain	
Match Referee and/or Core Group	
Submission Time	

APPENDIX C - MATCH SCORESHEET

TEMPLATE

Match Detail	Entry
Tournament	
Date / Time	
Court	
Home Team	
Away Team	
Main Referee	
Assistant Referee	
Scorer	

Set Summary

Set	Home Score	Away Score	Winning Team	Duration / Notes
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Time-Out and Sanction Log

Set	Score	Team	Event	Player / Team Member	Notes

Set	Score	Team	Event	Player / Team Member	Notes

Final Result and Certification

Item	Entry
Final Match Score	
Winning Team	
Protest Noted?	Yes / No
Captain Confirmation - Home	
Captain Confirmation - Away	
Scorer Confirmation	
Referee Confirmation	

APPENDIX D - MATCH-DAY CHECKLISTS

D.1 Main Referee Checklist

- ☐ Inspect court, lines, net, posts, and playing area.
- ☐ Confirm official ball and match crew.
- ☐ Receive Participating Players Lists.
- ☐ Confirm Captain or Match Captain for each team.
- ☐ Administer coin toss under Sections 7.5 or 7.6.
- ☐ Confirm starting lineups and flank assignments.
- ☐ Brief scorer on rotation and time-out tracking.
- ☐ Start match only when both teams and record are ready.
- ☐ Record unusual rulings, injury replacements, protests, and sanctions.
- ☐ Confirm final score before releasing teams.

D.2 Official Scorer Checklist

- ☐ Enter match identification and official names.
- ☐ Record declared players and starting order.
- ☐ Track set score and service order.
- ☐ Record two-minute team time-outs.
- ☐ Record flank-rotation corrections and exceptional replacements.
- ☐ Record warnings, penalties, expulsions, and disqualifications.
- ☐ Note any formal protest at the time directed by the referee.
- ☐ Confirm final score and winner with the referee.

D.3 Team Captain Checklist

- ☐ Confirm player availability before match day.
- ☐ Arrive at least 15 minutes before the match.
- ☐ Submit 4 to 8 Participating Players.
- ☐ List remaining present members as substitutes / inactive.
- ☐ Identify Captain / Match Captain and flank assignments.
- ☐ Participate in coin toss.
- ☐ Keep team-area conduct under control.
- ☐ Raise permitted questions through the referee, not through group confrontation.
- ☐ Verify final score and report record errors promptly.

APPENDIX E - STANDINGS, SEEDING, AND BRACKET EXAMPLES

E.1 Sample Standings Table

Seed	Team	MP	SW	SL	SR	PF	PA	PR
1	Team A	9	6	1	6.000	170	135	1.259
2	Team B	7	5	3	1.667	188	170	1.106
3	Team C	4	3	4	0.750	151	160	0.944
4	Team D	1	1	6	0.167	122	166	0.735

E.2 Tie-Break Example

If Team B and Team C finish with equal Match Points, compare Set Ratio. If still tied, compare Point Ratio. If still tied, apply Head-to-Head. If the tie remains unresolved, the Core Group administers a coin toss.

E.3 Illustrative Bracket

EVENT-SPECIFIC: The exact playoff structure must be published in the event bulletin. The example below is illustrative and does not override a published tournament bracket.

Stage	Team / Source	Advancement
League Seed 1	Highest seed	May advance directly to Final when the event bulletin uses that format.
Semi-Final	Seed 2 vs Seed 3	Winner advances to Final.
Championship Final	Seed 1 vs Semi-Final winner	Winner becomes Champion.
Placement Match	As published	May determine runner-up, second runner-up, or other placement.

APPENDIX F - CODE OF CONDUCT

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

By signing below, the participant acknowledges that they have received access to the CCVF Official Tournament Handbook and agree to follow its rules and standards.

- I will respect teammates, opponents, officials, volunteers, organizers, and spectators.
- I will compete honestly and accept responsibility for my conduct.
- I will communicate concerns through the appropriate team leader and protest process.
- I will not engage in threatening, discriminatory, abusive, or physically aggressive conduct.
- I will follow safety directions and report dangerous conditions promptly.
- I understand that violations may result in match or tournament sanctions.

Participant Information	Entry
Printed Name	
Team	
Signature	
Date	
Parent / Guardian, if required	

APPENDIX G - GLOSSARY AND ABBREVIATIONS

Term	Definition
CCVF	Coventry Chase Volleyball Federation.
Core Group	Tournament Organizers, Captains, Vice-Captains, and invited technical members acting as the governing body.
Event Bulletin	A tournament-specific publication containing the schedule, bracket, court, or approved supplemental regulations.
Flank Player	A declared Participating Player positioned outside the court who enters through an authorized exchange point.
Match-Day Roster	All eligible team members listed for the match; there is no numerical limit under this draft.
Participating Player	One of the 4 to 8 players formally declared and eligible to enter a specific match.
Substitute / Inactive	A registered match-day roster member not included among the declared Participating Players.
MP	Match Points.
SR	Set Ratio: sets won divided by sets lost.
PR	Point Ratio: points for divided by points against.
Position 4	Front Left court position and left flank exchange point.
Position 2	Front Right court position and right flank exchange point.

DRAFT REVIEW CHECKLIST

The following items should be confirmed before the handbook is approved as Official Version 1.0:

- Confirm the seven-player flank-rotation method in Section 10.7 and Appendix A.
- Confirm whether a standardized administrative score will be used for forfeits.
- Confirm the official warm-up duration.
- Confirm standard net height or event-specific net-height publication method.
- Confirm whether ordinary tactical substitutions are permitted within the declared Participating Players, or whether all seven/eight-player movement occurs only through flank rotation.
- Confirm the standard playoff bracket and any second runner-up placement match.
- Insert official CCVF logo and approved brand colors if available.
- Enter approval names, signatures, effective date, and distribution date.

DOCUMENT STATUS: Complete Draft Version 1.0. This document contains the full proposed handbook structure and all core regulations discussed to date. Highlighted review items should be resolved before official adoption.